Speak out
3RD EDITION

B1+
PROGRESS TEST 1 | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Choose the correct option (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 She offered me tea because she ___ any coffee left.
a didn't have **b** wasn't having **c** hadn't had
2 I took the bus that day because my car ___ down the day before.
a was breaking **b** has broken **c** had broken
3 She ___ hockey when she fell and hurt her ankle.
a played **b** was playing **c** 'd played
4 They ___ in a caravan for a while until they found a flat.
a 're living **b** were living **c** 've been living
5 She ___ me how to use the computer program last week.
a 's showed **b** showed **c** 's been showing
6 They ___ that new road for the last two years.
a build **b** 've built **c** 've been building
7 How long ___ for a new job?
a has she been looking **b** is she looking
c she has been looking
8 He ___ eating vegetables since he was little.
a 's hated **b** 's been hating **c** hates

/8

2 Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1 After several tough interviews, she succeeded in _____ (get) the job.
2 I live in the city now, but I grew up _____ (live) in the countryside.
3 Did you remember _____ (bring) an umbrella? It's going to rain.
4 She put off _____ (buy) a new laptop until she had more money.
5 Omar stopped _____ (talk) to me this morning and we had a good chat.

/5

3 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

apart	**except**	**not even**	**talking**	**to talk**
to use	**when**	**who**	**whose**	**which**

1 I always go to bed late so I never get much sleep, _____ when I'm tired.
2 Were you there _____ Erin fell in the river?
3 The party was great _____ it finished too early.
4 The manager is the person _____ on the phone.
5 _____ from Helga, none of us want to watch TV.
6 I know someone _____ grandmother was a famous actress.
7 Who was the last person _____ the bathroom?

/7

VOCABULARY

4 Complete the sentences with the missing words.

1 These trainers are a bit **d** _ _ _ _ _ **d**, but you can probably repair them.
2 She **i** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **d** some money from her grandfather when he died.
3 The necklace was a gift from her husband so it's very **s** _ _ _ _ _ **l** to her.
4 They live in an expensive area so their house is probably **w** _ _ _ **h** a lot of money.
5 I don't think those shoes are made of **l** _ _ _ _ _ **r**. They look like plastic to me.
6 We've got a **s** _ _ _ **e** wall at the bottom of our garden.
7 I prefer to wear **c** _ _ _ _ **n** clothes because it's cooler than other materials.

/7

5 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box.

appreciate	**dream**	**give pleasure**	
make an effort	**manage**	**not for me**	**stick to**
take up			

1 Working as a computer games tester would be my _____ job.
2 I tried a no-sugar diet, but it was _____. I like chocolate and cake too much.
3 I gave her old toys to a charity so they can _____ to another child.
4 Thank you for all your help. I really _____ it.
5 She didn't _____ with her homework so I've asked her to do it again.
6 I'd love to _____ a hobby, but I don't have time to start something new.
7 I didn't _____ to finish the book so I'll return it to the library next week.
8 We need to _____ the plan. Let's not change it now.

/8

6 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 Do you **feel like** / **happy to** cooking this evening?
2 I only agreed with them to **avoid** / **do** an argument.
3 She **got upset** / **felt comfortable** after she failed the exam.
4 Do you think you could **do** / **make** me a favour?
5 He feels **fault** / **guilty** because he didn't help her.

/5

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HOW TO …

7 Match the sentence beginnings (1–10) with the endings (a–j).

1 Don't forget to lock ___
2 I think we should go ___
3 I wonder if you would ___
4 Leave a message and I'll ___
5 Do you think you could ___
6 I can't stop now, I'm in ___
7 We'd like everyone to throw ___
8 It really gets on my ___
9 The children were continually ___
10 Don't get him started ___

a their litter away in the recycling bins.
b mind lending me your book.
c on people driving too fast.
d check this essay for me?
e sending messages on their mobiles.
f up your bicycle when you go into town.
g a hurry to get to the bank.
h get back to you as soon as I can.
i nerves when people don't listen to me.
j over our notes before the meeting.

/10

Total: /50

Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT1.01] Listen to a radio programme in which the interviewer asks people what they have got in their bags. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Jody is looking forward to checking a report this evening. **T** / **F**
2 Jody hasn't got any money except for some coins. **T** / **F**
3 Jody's sister gave her the hairbrush a long time ago. **T** / **F**
4 Jody appreciates the material the hairbrush is made from. **T** / **F**
5 Ruben doesn't have his phone with him today. **T** / **F**
6 Ruben has managed to give up eating sweets. **T** / **F**
7 Ruben is enjoying the book he is reading at the moment. **T** / **F**
8 Carla broke the screen on her phone when she dropped it. **T** / **F**
9 Carla's water bottle is made of a strong metal. **T** / **F**
10 Carla's friend wanted her to avoid using plastic water bottles. **T** / **F**

/10

2 [Audio PT1.02] Listen to five people talking about habits they want to change. Match the speakers (1–5) with the statements (A–E).

1 Angela ___
2 Darren ___
3 Emma ___
4 Neil ___
5 Paula ___

A My habit stops me thinking carefully about other things.
B My habit has made me get unnecessary things.
C My habit is worse at certain times of the year.
D My habit causes problems for the environment.
E My habit has had a negative effect on my body.

/5

3 [Audio PT1.02] Listen again. Choose the correct answer (A, B or C).

1 What is Angela planning to do?
A She's going to use public transport more often.
B She's going to stop using her car at the weekend.
C She's only going to use her car for going to work.

2 How does Darren feel about fast food?
A It's the cheapest way to buy his lunch.
B It's better to avoid eating it completely.
C It's the easiest thing to eat when he's in a rush.

3 How does Emma hope to change her habit?
A She's not going to use her phone anymore.
B She's going to check her phone less often.
C She's going to remove the apps from her phone.

4 What does Neil say about getting up?
A He doesn't mind getting up when it's light.
B He didn't manage to get up early today.
C He has always found it hard to get up.

5 What does Paula say about shopping?
A She has taken a shopping app off her phone.
B She doesn't feel comfortable going to shops.
C She managed to avoid buying a jacket online.

/5

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READING

4 Read a magazine article in which people talk about their favourite childhood possessions. Are the ideas from the article (1–5) Facts (F) or Opinions (O)?

1 It's good for Marcel's children to spend time outdoors. **F** / **O**
2 Children spend half as much time outdoors as their parents. **F** / **O**
3 Aisha's parents felt guilty about working a lot. **F** / **O**
4 Up to 35 percent of adults take soft toys to bed with them. **F** / **O**
5 Aisha's parents had thrown out her blanket. **F** / **O**

/5

Our favourite childhood possessions

Readers tell us about the things they loved most when they were children.

Marcel

I'm always trying to encourage my kids to spend more time outdoors because I think it's good for them. In fact, I've just read an article online that said these days children spend half as much time outdoors as their parents. I think that's true because, when I was growing up, I didn't spend much time in the house. I remember riding around on my bike for hours, looking for adventures. There was a group of us who used to race around the park or cycle out to the countryside. We all appreciated the feeling of freedom that we had.

At first, I had a really old bike that had belonged to my older brother. It was made of heavy steel and riding it was hard work. I really struggled with it when we went off-road and I was jealous of my friends' newer bikes. However, I was given a brand new mountain bike for my fourteenth birthday and it was definitely my favourite childhood possession. It was a really special present because I'd dreamt about getting one for years. It wasn't any lighter than my old bike, but that didn't bother me. I had the best and newest bike in my group of friends and that was the most important thing!

Aisha

I was a lucky child because I had all sorts of nice toys. I didn't have any brothers or sisters so my parents had more money to spend on me. They were always working and I think they felt guilty about that so they were always giving me things. However, the possession that meant most to me was an old blanket which I'd had since I was a baby. I couldn't do without that blanket and I took it everywhere. It was a soft blue blanket made of wool and I can still remember its smell even now.

I saw an article recently that said it's common for people to keep using things like blankets for many years. Apparently, as many as 35 percent of adults still take soft toys to bed with them, so it doesn't seem strange that I didn't give up my blanket. However, I think my parents were embarrassed and they probably wanted me to stop using it. Then one day, just after my tenth birthday, my blanket disappeared. I looked everywhere for it, but I couldn't find it. I was really upset because it was so special to me. It was only a few years ago when I found out that my parents had thrown it out!

5 Read the article again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 What does Marcel think about children's activities?
A His children don't spend any time outdoors.
B His children spend too much time indoors.
C Children don't appreciate riding bikes anymore.
D Children shouldn't ride their bikes in the park.

2 What does Marcel say about his first bike?
A He had to share it with his older brother.
B His older brother used to ride it to work.
C It was difficult to ride because of the material.
D It was a present for his fourteenth birthday.

3 Why was Marcel pleased with his favourite possession?
A He had wanted one for a long time.
B He once had a dream about one.
C It wasn't as heavy as his first bike.
D It was just like the bikes his friends had.

4 What does Aisha say about her blanket?
A It had belonged to her parents.
B It was worth a lot of money.
C She needed to have it at all times.
D She didn't appreciate its smell.

5 What happened to Aisha's favourite possession?
A Her parents asked her to stop using it.
B She got a new one on her tenth birthday.
C She threw it away when she grew up.
D Her parents had put it in the rubbish.

/10

6 Read an article about how to become more confident. What is the writer's purpose for using the quotes (1–5)? Choose the correct option (a or b).

1 'I was the most stressed person you've ever met.' (paragraph 1)
- **a** to make the article more interesting
- **b** to make suggestions for the reader

2 'Don't try to be perfect.' (paragraph 2)
- **a** to explain why the reader needs to take some advice
- **b** to give the reader an idea of what to do in the situation

3 'I'm going to walk away from this negative situation and try to calm down.' (paragraph 3)
- **a** to help show how the tip might work in practice
- **b** to show why the writer decided to make a suggestion

4 'Right now, I'm washing the car and that's all I'm going to think about.' (paragraph 4)
- **a** to explain why some people have a problem
- **b** to give an example of the suggestion which was just made

5 'I'm ready to become calmer and less stressed. I'm going to take control of my life.' (paragraph 5)
- **a** to create a connection with the reader
- **b** to say what the reader will do in future

/5

How to become a calmer person

By Natalie Thomas

[1]I've been helping people manage their stress and become calmer for the last ten years. The first time I meet a client, I always tell them, 'I was the most stressed person you've ever met.' It surprises them, but helps them realise that you don't have to live with stress. Like me, you can control it so that you're able to lead a calmer and more relaxed life. In this article, I'm going to share some of my favourite advice with you.

[2]A lot of the people I meet want everything in their lives to be perfect. When things go wrong, they often think that it's their fault and that makes them stressed. The problem is, you can't manage difficult situations well if you feel like that. In those situations, my advice to you is 'don't try to be perfect'. Just accept that life is not perfect! As long as you do your best, you shouldn't feel guilty about making mistakes or not being successful.

[3]People who are stressed also tend to blame other people when there are problems. Even if you're right, blaming people often leads to arguments. Apart from not being a good way to solve problems, arguing has never helped anyone to relax. The physical sensations, like a fast heartbeat and feeling hot, are a clear sign that arguing is bad for you. I'd recommend avoiding arguments whenever you can. Just say to yourself, 'I'm going to walk away from this negative situation and try to calm down.'

[4]Another important piece of advice is to slow your life down. We lead such busy lives that we are always thinking about the next thing we have to do. Rather than worrying about the next thing, concentrate on what you're doing now. For example, if you're washing your car, say to yourself, 'Right now, I'm washing the car and that's all I'm going to think about.' If you do that, you'll probably be happy to do even the most boring tasks. This is called 'living in the moment,' and we should all make an effort to do it more often.

[5]If you follow my advice, you'll find that your life will become calmer. It won't happen straightaway and I'd recommend setting yourself small goals. For example, 'This month I'm going to work on avoiding arguments.' If you stick to those goals, you will achieve them sooner or later and you'll see that it's possible to have a better life. If you're feeling stressed, don't put off making the necessary changes. Just tell yourself, 'I'm ready to become calmer and less stressed. I'm going to take control of my life.'

7 Read the article again. Are the statements true (T) or false (F)?

1 The writer has spent more than ten years helping people. **T** / **F**
2 The writer used to get stressed out in difficult situations. **T** / **F**
3 The writer thinks people often blame themselves when things go wrong. **T** / **F**
4 The writer thinks that trying to be perfect can cause stress. **T** / **F**
5 The writer thinks it is a good idea to blame people when they are wrong. **T** / **F**
6 The writer mentions how stress can affect the way your body feels. **T** / **F**
7 The writer thinks you should try to concentrate on the next thing you have to do. **T** / **F**
8 The writer thinks it is possible to get pleasure from boring tasks. **T** / **F**
9 The writer thinks her advice can have an immediate effect on the reader. **T** / **F**
10 The writer suggests delaying making any changes if you're not feeling calm. **T / F**

/10

Total: /50

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Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Make questions and ask your partner.

1 What / doing / last / Saturday morning?
2 What toys / remember / playing with / as / child?
3 What / do / when / in a bad mood?
4 Have / reading / anything interesting / lately?
5 How / feel / when / somebody / jumps / queue?

/5

2 Answer your partner's questions.

/5

3 Describe the picture to your partner. Why are the people arguing?



/10

WRITING

4 Complete the sentences with the words in the box. There are three words you do not need.

brand comes condition else genuine get instead used

1 This calculator is _____ new and it has never been used.
2 I'll _____ back to you as soon as I can.
3 This set of plates _____ in its original box.
4 Could we arrange it for Wednesday _____?
5 These gloves are made from _____ Moroccan leather.

/5

5 Read the invitations. Write an email to decline each one.

To: Matt
cc:
Subject: Cinema

Hi,

What are you doing on Friday night? There's a film I want to see at the cinema. It's that new French film that you were talking about. If you can't go on Friday, maybe we can find another day. Let me know as soon as you can.

BW
Zadie

To: Liam Bradley
cc:
Subject: Work trip

Dear Liam,

We're pleased to announce that we're organising another work trip this year. It will be a great opportunity to spend time with your colleagues in a relaxed setting. We're planning to organise the trip on the first weekend of June. However, if you're unable to attend then, please let me know as soon as possible. We may be able to change the date if it's not convenient for everyone.

Regards,
Sonia, HR Manager

Write 100–140 words in total.

/15

Total: /40